



ISRAELI STRIKE KILLS 5 JOURNALISTS IN GAZA

■ People attend the funeral of members of the press who were killed in an Israeli strike, at Al Awda Hospital in the Nuseirat refugee camp in central Gaza Strip, yesterday. A Palestinian TV channel said five of its journalists were killed in the strike. A missile hit the journalists' broadcast truck as it was parked in the Nuseirat camp. **SEE ALSO P8**

India's former Prime Minister Manmohan Singh dies at 92

Modi pays rich tributes as nation mourns loss of one of its most distinguished leaders

NEW DELHI

India's former prime minister Manmohan Singh died yesterday aged 92 after he was admitted to hospital for an illness, the country's leader Narendra Modi said.

Singh, who held the office from 2004 to 2014, oversaw an economic boom in Asia's fourth-largest economy in his



■ Manmohan Singh

first term and was known as a loyalist to the Gandhi political dynasty.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi condoled the demise

of Singh saying that India mourns the loss of one of its most distinguished leaders.

"India mourns the loss of one of its most distinguished leaders, Dr. Manmohan Singh Ji. Rising from humble origins, he rose to become a respected economist. He served in various government positions as well, including as Finance Minister, leaving a strong imprint on our economic policy over the years," he wrote on X.

Manmohan Singh, born in Punjab in 1932, served two terms as prime minister of India from 2004 to 2014. —Agencies **SEE ALSO P12**

Road safety tops residents' concerns

ABU DHABI
BY ABDULLA RASHEED
Abu Dhabi Editor

Road safety has emerged as the top concern for the community in a public opinion survey conducted by Abu Dhabi Police.

The poll, launched on the police's social media channels, aimed to identify the most important content for its followers in 2024. The results showed that the public's interest in road safety and traffic awareness was highest for content shared by Abu Dhabi Police.

Brig Gen Mohammad Ali Al Muhairi, Director of the Security Media Department at the Leadership Affairs Sector, said the public's engagement with such surveys underscores the community's responsiveness to Abu Dhabi Police's messages and campaigns aimed at raising drivers' awareness of traffic rules.

New hand baggage rules for Indian airlines

Regulations apply to both domestic and international flights

DUBAI
BY LEKSHMY PAVITHRAN
Assistant Online Editor

Indian aviation authorities have introduced stricter size and weight restrictions for carry-on luggage to enhance security and improve airport efficiency.

Passengers, whether on domestic or international flights, may carry only one cabin bag on board. Any additional luggage must be checked in.

The weight allowance for Economy and Premium Economy passengers is 7kg while it is 10kg for Business and First Class travellers. As for dimensions of the carry-on luggage, for all classes it should measure 55cm in height, 40cm in length and 20cm in width.

However, passengers with tickets purchased before May

4, 2024, are allowed higher weight limits: Economy — up to 8kg; Premium Economy — up to 10 kg; Business and First Class — up to 12kg.

Airline-specific policies

Air India: Complies with the one-bag limit, allowing a 7kg bag for economy passengers and 10 kg for business class.

IndiGo Airlines: Permits one cabin bag (maximum 7kg and 115cm in combined dimensions) and a small personal item like a purse or laptop bag, up to 3kg.

By limiting cabin baggage, authorities aim to expedite the boarding process; reduce security delays; and ensure a more organised cabin environment for passengers and crew.

7kg weight permitted for carry-on luggage on Indian airlines

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GCC rejects interference in Syria affairs

STRESSES NEED FOR TRANSITION THAT ENSURES PEACE AND DIGNITY

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC) reaffirmed its commitment to respecting Syria's sovereignty, independence and territorial integrity, rejecting foreign interference and urging global action to confront terrorism and extremism.

At the 46th extraordinary meeting in Kuwait, chaired by Kuwaiti Foreign Minister Abdullah Ali Abdullah Al Yahya, the GCC emphasised Syria's pivotal role in regional stability and called for a Syrian-led political transition that ensures peace, development and dignity for its people.

The foreign ministers denounced repeated Israeli attacks on Syria, including the occupation of the border buffer zone and expansion in the Golan Heights, calling for an end to violations of international law.

Call to lift sanctions

The ministers urged the international community to lift

ASSAD ALLY HELD

Syria's new rulers have arrested a military justice official under the ousted government of president Bashar Al Assad who issued death sentences in the notorious Saydnaya prison.

Mohammad Kanjo Hassan was arrested in the coastal Tartus province, a stronghold of Assad's clan, along with 20 members of his entourage. The arrest was part of an operation launched by security forces against pro-Assad militias in the western province of Tartus.

sanctions on Syria and provide full economic support, emphasizing the importance of humanitarian aid and refugee resettlement.

The GCC also reaffirmed support for Lebanon's sovereignty and stability, urging comprehensive reforms to resolve its crises and prevent the country from being exploited for terrorism or drug trafficking.

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